

Killer rigs

We tell you about the best components to look for at various PC rigs at different budgets

Price watch

This time it's all about routers and 2 in one laptops or what some people prefer to call convertibles.

Frag with no limits on a gaming laptop

The rules of the game when you're going for a gaming laptop

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You're a Gamer. Gaming is your life. Eat, game, sleep... repeat. That's pretty much your mantra. You don't want a cute laptop, neither should you settle for a mediocre machine that calls itself a "budget gaming notebook" – because there's no such thing! For gamers, only the best hardware will do. The best hardware, super-sized... to the max. All hail #PCMasterRace

Do not compromise on these specs

GPU is everything!

Without a high-end discrete (or dedicated) GPU from NVIDIA or AMD, your gaming laptop is severely handicapped. Don't settle for Intel HD graphics, obviously, because it's peanuts in comparison to NVIDIA's GeForce GTX 960M/980M or AMD Radeon R7/R9 graphics chips. This should be the bare minimum a gaming laptop should sport. However, NVIDIA GeForce GTX 1060 / 1070 / 1080 are the best current-gen GPUs available on high-end gaming laptops.

Another crucial point about GPUs is that unlike desktop GPUs that can be removed and replaced, a laptop's GPU is soldered onto its motherboard. You can't replace the GPU without replacing the motherboard, in most cases. Even if you have to extend your budget by a bit, definitely buy a gaming laptop with the best-possible GPU outright at the time of purchase.

CPU & RAM matters

After the GPU, pay attention to a laptop's CPU, as it's the heart of the machine. Don't even consider Intel's Core i3 chips, a gaming laptop should at least have an Intel Core i5 processor, and ideally the Core i7 processor. The latest generation of Intel processors is called Sky Lake and denoted by a four digit number that starts with seven – "7xxx". You can learn more nuances of Intel CPU nomenclature online, but as far as gaming laptops go try to focus on machines that sport either an "HQ" or "U" suffix. Also, the higher its clock speed, the better. So a 2.8 GHz processor is better than 2.1 GHz processor.

RAM directly affects your laptop's speed. When a game is launched, its data is loaded and temporarily resides in a laptop's RAM. So, greater the RAM the better, and the same goes for the clock frequency. DDR4 is the latest generation of RAM, an upgrade over DDR3. In any case, a gaming laptop

should have at least 8GB of DDR3 RAM. The more the merrier..

Speed vs Storage

Should a gaming laptop have traditional HDD or an SSD? SSD is based on flash-memory, which is quick to boot and a lot faster than traditional spinning HDD (hard drive). But higher-capacity SSDs are a lot costlier than HDDs. Most good gaming laptops, hence, try to offer a nice balance between the two. They have at least 16 or 32GB SSD paired with a traditional large-capacity 500GB or 1TB HDD, in the form of a hybrid drive. This ensures the operating system and game files launch quickly, because of the SSD, and also offers you the flexibility of installing a large number of games because of the HDD's capacity.

Keyboard > Trackpad

A trackpad is useless in a gaming laptop – don't give it any thought. Pay

